



YOU ARE **33 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS**

43 days to go...

YOUR BABY TODAY

Your baby is now capable of producing all of the enzymes that will process food within the digestive tract. If born early, your baby could now feed normally, although some will still require help since they need to fine-tune the coordination of their suckling reflexes.

“Your baby is naturally nourished inside the uterus and her own digestive tract is now functioning well.”

Although the placenta grows most rapidly in the first three months, it becomes increasingly important in transferring nutrients and energy to your baby in the last trimester.

The carbohydrates you eat are broken down into glucose and the placenta transfers glucose to your baby for her own energy needs. This includes converting some glucose into protective fat reserves. These reserves are important because if your baby is born too early, she won't have had time to accumulate enough fat to keep herself warm.

The protein you eat is broken down into its constituent amino acids. The placenta keeps about 30 percent more amino acids circulating in your baby's blood than in yours. Eating protein is vital to build new cells and your unborn baby's vital organs.

Fats from your diet are essential this trimester. They are split up and cross the placenta to your baby as omega-3 fatty acids. These are used to make essential tissues, such as those that help develop the nervous system, and those that help the brain and eyes develop properly.

GETTING UP FROM LYING DOWN

After you've exercised on the floor, or have been resting in bed, you may find it a struggle to get up from lying down. This simple maneuver can put a strain on your abdominal muscles, which are stretched, and it isn't helped by your altered center of gravity. The technique shown below was originally devised by yoga teachers. As with any strenuous maneuvers at this stage of pregnancy, always take your time and remember to breathe slowly and deeply throughout.